



TO: The Honorable Members of the Board of Regents

FROM: Angelique Johnson-Dingle *Angelique Johnson-Dingle*

SUBJECT: Proposed Amendment of Section 100.2 of the Regulations of the Commissioner of Education to Require Instruction in Personal Finance Education and Climate Education

DATE: February 26, 2026

AUTHORIZATIONS:

Don M. B. *Betty M.*
Summary

Issue for Decision (Consent)

Should the Board of Regents adopt the proposed amendment of section 100.2 of the Regulations of the Commissioner of Education to require instruction in personal finance education and climate education?

Reason for Consideration

Review of policy.

Proposed Handling

The proposed amendment is submitted to the Full Board for adoption as a permanent rule at the March 2026 meeting. A copy of the proposed amendment (Attachment A) is attached.

Procedural History

The proposed amendment was presented to the P-12 Education Committee for discussion at the November 2025 Regents meeting. A Notice of Proposed Rule Making was published in the State Register on November 19, 2025, for a 60-day comment period. Following publication in the State Register, the Department received comments on the proposed amendment. An Assessment of Public Comment is included (Attachment B). No changes to the proposed amendment are recommended at this time. If adopted at the March 2026 meeting, a Notice of Adoption will be published in the State Register on March 25, 2026. Supporting materials are available upon request to the Secretary of the Board of Regents.

Background Information

In November 2023, the Blue Ribbon Commission on Graduation Measures (“BRC” or “Commission”) presented recommendations to the Board of Regents. The Graduation Measures Initiative was an unprecedented effort that brought together student voices along with a diverse range of stakeholders including parents, educators, administrators, school support staff, representatives of higher education, and the business community. The BRC created a roadmap for learning-centered education that best meets the needs of every student in New York State (NYS) and incorporates competency imperatives that provide them with the practical skills needed for the dynamic demands of tomorrow’s workforce. As leaders in education, the Blue Ribbon Commission members were mindful of the need to prepare New York State graduates for success in a complex and rapidly changing world and to ensure they have the knowledge and life skills necessary to navigate 21st-century life.

In November 2024, the Department presented NY Inspires: A Plan to Transform Education in New York State. This plan included a timeline for implementing the four key transformations for implementing the recommendations of the BRC. As part of Phase 1, consistent with the Commission’s recommendations, the Department is proposing to amend section 100.2 of the Commissioner’s regulations to require instruction in personal finance education and climate education for public school students in grades kindergarten (K) through 12. The proposed amendment provides that instruction in personal finance education and climate education shall be provided by the end of the last year of each grade band – elementary, middle, and high school. Specifically, such instruction must be provided to elementary school students by the end of grade 4, to middle school students by the end of grade 8, and to high school students by the end of grade 12.

Additionally, the proposed amendment provides for a multi-year phase-in approach for the new instructional requirements for personal finance education and climate education as follows:

New Instructional Requirement	Middle Grade Band (Grades 5–8) and High School Grade Band (Grades 9–12)	Elementary Grade Band (Grades K–4)
Personal Finance Education	Beginning with the 2026–2027 school year (SY)	Beginning with the 2027–2028 SY
Climate Education	Beginning with the 2027–2028 SY	Beginning with the 2028–2029 SY

The phased rollout of these instructional requirements over multiple years and by grade band will allow for the greatest flexibility in local implementation. While public schools must begin to provide instruction in personal finance education and climate education in the years identified in the chart above, they do not need to wait for the established timelines for each grade band to begin implementation. For example, in the 2026-2027 school year, public schools could provide instruction in personal finance education to students in the elementary grade band and/or instruction in climate education to students in one or more of the grade bands.

Additionally, under the proposed amendment, each year during the phase-in, school districts will be required to submit verification to the Commissioner of Education that it has implemented instruction in personal finance education and climate education within the grade bands prescribed in the regulations.

The Department is working with stakeholders on the development of comprehensive guidance to proactively support public schools with the effective implementation of high quality, culturally responsive personal finance education, and climate education in grades K-12, with flexibility to meet their local needs. The guidance will include, among other things, broad topics to be integrated into K-12 educational programs. For personal finance education, the topics include Budgeting and Money Management, Credit and Debt Management, Earning Income, Risk Management, and Savings and Investing. For climate education, these topics include Causes of Climate Change, Impacts of Climate Change, and Solutions for Climate Change. Objectives for each of these topics will be developed for the elementary, middle, and high school grade bands to ensure a comprehensive and developmentally appropriate progression of instruction in personal finance education and climate education. In addition, the Department will issue instructions for public schools on how to submit the verification of implementation of instruction in personal finance education and climate education.

Related Regents Items

[November 2025: Proposed Amendment of Section 100.2 of the Regulations of the Commissioner of Education to Require Instruction in Personal Finance Education and Climate Education](https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/1125p12d1.pdf)

(<https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/1125p12d1.pdf>)

[July 2025: Proposed Adoption of the New York State Portrait of a Graduate](https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/725bra8.pdf)

(<https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/725bra8.pdf>)

[March 2025: Proposed Amendment of Sections 100.5\(a\) and \(b\) and 100.4\(d\) of the Regulations of the Commissioner of Education Relating to Exemptions from Diploma Assessment Requirements for Major Life Events](https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/325p12a2.pdf)

(<https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/325p12a2.pdf>)

[November 2024: NY Inspires: A Plan to Transform Education in New York State](https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/FB%20Monday%20-%20Graduation%20Measures%20Update.pdf)

(<https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/FB%20Monday%20-%20Graduation%20Measures%20Update.pdf>)

[June 2024: New York State Graduation Measures Initiative: A Transformational Vision](https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/FB%20Monday%20-%20New%20York%20State%20Graduation%20Measures%20Initiative%20-%20.pdf)
(<https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/FB%20Monday%20-%20New%20York%20State%20Graduation%20Measures%20Initiative%20-%20.pdf>)

[May 2024: New York State Graduation Measures Initiative: Board of Regents Update](https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/FB%20Monday%20-%20New%20York%20State%20Graduation%20Measures%20Initiative_0.pdf)
(https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/FB%20Monday%20-%20New%20York%20State%20Graduation%20Measures%20Initiative_0.pdf)

[November 2023: New York State Graduation Measures Initiative: Recommendations from the Blue Ribbon Commission](https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/FB%20Monday%20-%20New%20York%20State%20Graduation%20Measures%20Initiative.pdf)
(<https://www.regents.nysed.gov/sites/regents/files/FB%20Monday%20-%20New%20York%20State%20Graduation%20Measures%20Initiative.pdf>)

Recommendation

It is recommended that the Board of Regents take the following action:

VOTED: That section 100.2 of the Regulations of the Commissioner of Education be amended, as submitted, effective March 25, 2026.

Timetable for Implementation

If adopted at the March 2026 meeting, the proposed amendment will become effective as a permanent rule on March 25, 2026.

AMENDMENT TO THE REGULATIONS OF THE COMMISSIONER OF EDUCATION

Pursuant to sections 101, 207, 208, 209, 305, 309, and 3204 of the Education Law.

1. Subdivision (c) of section 100.2 of the Regulations of the Commissioner of Education is amended by adding two new paragraphs (13) and (14) to read as follows:

(13) for all public school students in grades kindergarten through 12, instruction in personal finance education, as follows:

(i) Beginning with the 2026-2027 school year and thereafter, such instruction shall be provided to middle school students by the end of grade 8 and high school students by the end of grade 12.

(ii) Beginning with the 2027-2028 school year and thereafter, such instruction shall be provided to elementary school students by the end of grade 4.

(iii) For the 2026-2027, 2027-2028, and 2028-2029 school years, each school district shall verify to the commissioner that it has implemented instruction in personal finance education in accordance with the requirements of this paragraph.

(14) for all public school students in grades kindergarten through 12, instruction in climate education, as follows:

(i) Beginning with the 2027-2028 school year and thereafter, such instruction shall be provided to middle school students by the end of grade 8 and high school students by the end of grade 12.

(ii) Beginning with the 2028-2029 school year and thereafter, such instruction shall be provided to elementary school students by the end of grade 4.

(iii) For the 2027-2028 and 2028-2029 school years, each school district shall verify to the commissioner that it has implemented instruction in climate education consistent with the requirements of this paragraph.

ASSESSMENT OF PUBLIC COMMENT

Following the publication of a Notice of Proposed Rulemaking in the State Register on November 19, 2025, the State Education Department (SED or the “Department”) received the following public comments on the proposed rule:

General

1. COMMENT: The majority of commenters generally supported personal finance and climate education. Supportive commenters noted that personal finance and climate education are essential components of civic and career readiness and for preparing students for postsecondary success; commenters also noted that the proposed rule provides equitable access to instruction, is consistent with Blue Ribbon Commission recommendations, provides flexibility in implementation, and equips students with information and tools to cope with climate change challenges and advocate for future. Commenters further noted that early exposure to financial education builds healthy financial habits and skills essential for all students. Commenters also noted that students want climate education which empowers students to take action and apply learning and is aligned to [NYS’s Portrait of a Graduate](#).

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: Since these comments were supportive no response necessary.

2. COMMENT: One commenter recommended decoupling climate and personal finance education requirements.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: While climate and personal finance are part of the same rulemaking, they are separate instructional requirements that do not require decoupling. Therefore, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

3. COMMENT: Commenters noted personal finance and climate content can be easily integrated into existing courses (e.g., computer science) and they encourage this to reduce burden and promote applied learning.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: The proposed rule provides flexibility in implementation and embedded instruction is one option for meeting instructional requirements. Therefore, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

4. COMMENT: One commenter requested that SED provide standards and resources for all student populations including students that are alternately assessed and English language learners.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: SED will develop guidance, including grade band objectives, to support implementation to meet the needs of all students. Thus, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

5. COMMENT: Some commenters requested research-based recommendations for minimum minutes to meet instructional requirements.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: Instructional time will vary depending on implementation options utilized. Therefore, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

6. COMMENT: Commenters noted the importance of educator preparation, professional development (PD), and interdisciplinary collaboration for effective implementation of the proposed rule. Commenters recommended integrating teachers' perspectives and practitioner research into the curriculum and PD; they also requested implementation guidance, including standards and resources for students that are alternately assessed and English language learners. Commenters further recommended expanded stakeholder engagement and stressed the importance of communicating new instructional requirements. Finally, commenters requested

clarification regarding the establishment and responsibilities of workgroups and the role of boards of cooperative education services (BOCES) and Teacher Centers in rollout/training.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: SED is working with stakeholders, including advisory committees/workgroups, on developing guidance to support effective implementation. BOCES and Teacher Centers are available to support local implementation. Additionally, these comments will be considered in guidance development. As a result, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

7. COMMENT: Commenters recommended ensuring adequate and sustained funding to avoid an unfunded mandate.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: SED cannot create or allocate funding in conjunction with rulemaking. Instructional requirements may be integrated into existing courses. In most cases, current staff will be able to deliver required instruction without incurring additional expenses. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary

Personal Finance

8. COMMENT: Numerous commenters recommended mandatory stand-alone personal finance courses. Commenters noted that NYS is one of two states projected not to earn an A in the HS Financial Literacy section of the National Report Card. Commenters also noted that the proposed rule allows for inconsistent implementation and that embedded instruction is ineffective. Many commenters recommended that personal finance should be a semester-long or half credit HS course and that it should also be a graduation requirement. One commenter asked if completing a SED-approved Career and Technical Education (CTE) program and 0.5 unit of Career and Financial Management (CFM) would meet the HS grade band requirement. Some commenters

recommended integrating personal finance into economics and mathematics courses while others recommended that economics not count for the instruction requirement.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: The proposed rule provides flexibility in delivery of personal finance instruction to meet local needs. Implementation options include stand-alone course(s), embedded instruction - including integration into economics and mathematics courses - and/or CTE programming that includes 0.5 unit of CFM. Each option holds equal value and would be locally determined. Thus, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

9. COMMENT: Commenter recommended delaying personal finance until grade 6 due to the limited time in a school day to address existing requirements and prepare for assessments.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: SED believes the multi-year phase-in of personal finance education by grade band provides sufficient time to support thoughtful planning and alignment with existing instructional programs. Thus, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

10. COMMENT: Commenters asked if 8th and 12th grade students in the 2026–2027 school year must complete personal finance instruction before exiting MS and HS grade bands or if incoming 5th and 9th grade cohorts must complete instruction by the exit year of each grade band. Another commenter recommended requiring personal finance in 11th and 12th grades.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: While the proposed rule requires the provision of personal finance instruction to MS and HS grade bands beginning in 2026-2027, schools have flexibility in determining how instruction is delivered and in what grades instruction is delivered within those bands. Fifth and ninth grade students entering MS and HS grade bands in the 2026-2027 school year must receive instruction aligned to

grade band objectives for each personal finance topic by the end of those bands. As a result, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

11. COMMENT: Commenters requested clarification regarding teacher certification required to teach personal finance education in different grade bands. Some commenters recommended requiring certification in business and marketing or family and consumer sciences (FACS) for stand-alone personal finance courses and CTE certification for SED-approved CTE programs. One commenter requested an option to allow individuals with finance or accounting degrees to teach personal finance courses.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: Personal finance instruction must be provided by appropriately certified NYS teachers. Local administration is responsible for determining staffing based on the implementation option(s) utilized at each grade band. Instruction could be provided by certified business and marketing and FACS teachers in courses where such certification is required per SED's [School Codes for the Exchange of Data \(SCED\) Course to Certification Crosswalk Workbook](#). Otherwise, changes to teacher certification requirements are outside the scope of proposed rule. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

12. COMMENT: Some commenters recommended specific personal finance curricula. One commenter urged SED to develop model statewide curriculum. Other commenters recommended including applied and project-based learning in personal finance instruction and schools partnering with credit unions.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: Education Law §1709(3) affords school districts local control to prescribe courses of study and their associated content. All curriculum

and instruction decisions are locally determined. SED does not require certain curricula. Thus, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

13. COMMENT: Commenters asked if standards/benchmarks or an outline/curriculum guide of required content for each grade band will be developed and whether an assessment will be required to determine if standards have been met. Commenter recommended adoption of a K-12 personal finance standards framework and updating CFM curriculum to align with national standards.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: SED is not creating new personal finance learning standards or adopting national standards. Grade band objectives will be developed for the five personal finance topics to ensure coherent and developmentally appropriate progression of learning. SED will review existing NYS Learning Standards across content areas to identify where interdisciplinary connections can be made to these topics. Schools will be responsible for locally determining if students have received instruction aligned to the grade band objectives for each topic. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

14. COMMENT: Commenters recommended that personal finance instruction also cover cybertheft, digital fraud protection, consumer skills, insurance, decision making, and nontraditional and gig economies.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: Instruction in these topics could be included under the five personal finance topics. These comments will be considered in development of grade band objectives for each topic. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

15. COMMENT: Commenters asked if eighth graders can be accelerated for personal finance education and get credit for both MS and HS grade bands.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: Nothing would prohibit schools from allowing eighth graders the opportunity to take a stand-alone personal finance course approved for HS

credit to the extent allowable under section 100.4(d) of the Commissioner's regulations. However, accelerated students would need to receive instruction addressing MS grade band objectives for each personal finance topic by the end of grade 7. Moreover, under the proposed rule, personal finance is an instructional requirement. The Department is not requiring personal finance coursework as a diploma requirement. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

16. COMMENT: Commenters requested implementation guidance with examples of real-world financial contexts.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: [Guidance and Resources](#) and [Frequently Asked Questions](#) (FAQ) are posted on SED's [Personal Finance Education](#) webpage. Additional guidance, including grade band objectives for personal finance topics, will be posted in the coming months to inform instructional planning. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

Climate

17. COMMENT: A few commenters did not support climate education, indicating it would divert time and resources from improving academic skills in math, science, engineering, technology, and literacy. Commenters also characterized climate education as political or ideological and questioned its scientific validity. One commenter also questioned how students will be educated on "climate challenges" and what facts will be utilized to do so.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: The Department disagrees that climate education is ideological or political. Rather, the Department recognizes the importance of preparing students with the knowledge and skills necessary to navigate 21st century climate challenges and to be able to contribute solutions. Integrating climate education into K-12 education provides opportunity for students to apply discipline-specific knowledge

and skills in meaningful ways while developing essential attributes of the Portrait of a Graduate. Finally, as noted above, all curriculum and instruction decisions are locally determined. As a result, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

18. COMMENT: Some commenters recommended that climate instruction start in the 2026-2027 school year.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: Schools are encouraged to begin implementation ahead of established grade band timelines as readiness and capacity may allow. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

19. COMMENT: Numerous commenters recommended requiring climate instruction throughout each grade band as waiting until the last year of each band may overlook the necessity of a spiraled educational model. They also recommended a cumulative assessment/project at the end of each grade band.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: The proposed rule provides local flexibility in determining when and how instruction is delivered based on local needs and capacity; this could include instruction at all grades within each band. Moreover, assessment decisions are locally determined. Thus, no changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

20. COMMENT: A commenter recommended that climate policy account for scientific understanding and community-rooted knowledge aligned to the Culturally Responsive-Sustaining Education Framework and commitment to equity. Another commenter recommended that climate instruction should include social-emotional learning components. Numerous commenters recommended that SED provide interdisciplinary exemplars/guidance and showcase successful models integrating climate education into existing content areas/curriculum, providing teachers multiple ways to approach climate education.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: SED will consider the comments in the development of the climate education grade band objectives and additional resources to support implementation of high-quality, culturally responsive instruction. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

21. COMMENT: Some commenters asked whether the required instruction in climate education is covered in the existing science standards, whether climate instruction should be provided in science alone, or if it should be an interdisciplinary experience.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: In order to meet local needs, the proposed rule provides flexibility for delivering climate instruction. Such flexibility could include embedded instruction that is intentionally integrated into existing subject areas (e.g., science, mathematics, social studies, etc.) based on local context, resources, and instructional design. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

22. COMMENT: A commenter recommended establishing common definitions for climate education to ensure that climate education is not conflated with environmental education.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: “Climate education” is already clearly defined in the Department’s [Climate FAQ](#) as “instruction to help students understand the causes of climate change, its impacts on natural and human systems, and the solutions and actions that individuals and communities can take to address it.” No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

23. COMMENT: Some commenters recommended changing the proposed grade bands to K-5, 6-8, and 9-12, consistent with the NY Science Learning Standards (NYSSLs).

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: The grade bands in the proposed rule align with the grade levels outlined in sections 100.3 through 100.5 of the Commissioner's regulations. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

24. COMMENT: Some commenters recommended replacing the term "solutions" for climate change with "responses" since solutions implies final, permanent fixes. Commenters also recommended including child health and equity solutions.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: "Solutions of Climate Change" encompasses a range of approaches including mitigation and adaptation. The comments will be considered in development of grade band objectives for the three climate education topics. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

25. COMMENT: The NYSSLS can be strengthened by including more explicit language highlighting climate change and its impacts.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: SED will be reviewing the existing NYS Learning Standards across content areas, including the NYSSLS to identify where interdisciplinary connections can be made to climate topics. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

26. COMMENT: Some commenters recommended SED establish formal consultation with community-based organizations and environmental organizations; develop an ecosystem of PD trainers including experienced educators and non-governmental organizations; require PD/Continuing Teacher and Leader Education hours in climate education; and require climate education in preservice preparation for K-12 certification.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: The comments are outside the scope of the proposed rule; no response is necessary.

27. COMMENT: A commenter recommended creating a Climate Literacy Seal.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: The comment is outside the scope of the proposed rule; no response is necessary.

Verification

28. COMMENT: Commenters asked how student learning and progress will be measured and proficiency and mastery defined, and what documentation must be maintained and tracked to verify compliance. Commenters requested clear verification criteria to ensure equity and SED's ability to monitor compliance, identify gaps, and support districts. One commenter recommended yearly verification.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: Guidance/instructions for submission of the required verification is forthcoming. No changes to the proposed rule are necessary.

Miscellaneous

29. COMMENT: A commenter expressed concern regarding the reading level of the Life Science: Biology Regents exam and the lack of test banks.

Another recommended that the new Advanced Placement Business and Personal Finance course be taught exclusively by certified business and marketing teachers.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSE: The comments are outside the scope of the proposed rule; no response is necessary.